

The draftwatermark package^{*}

Sergio Callegari[†]

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Abstract

The `draftwatermark` package extends $\LaTeX$ providing a means to add a watermark (typically textual and light gray, but possibly more sophisticated) on the pages of a document (either on every page, on the first page, or on selected pages). Typical usage may consist in writing words such as “DRAFT” or “CONFIDENTIAL” across the pages. The package may remind in some sense `draftcopy` by Dr. Juergen Vollmer, but its implementation is lighter (as the reduced code footprint shows) and does not rely on postscript specials, making the package fully compatible with $\pdf\LaTeX$, $\Xe\LaTeX$ and $\Lua\LaTeX$. Its feature set is somehow restricted because the emphasis is on the simplicity of the interface. For complex layouts, consider `scrlayer.sty` from the *KOMA script* bundle or directly using the new $\LaTeX$ shipout hooks.

1 Introduction

This package extends $\LaTeX$ providing a means to add a textual, usually light gray (but possibly colored) watermark on every page, the first page, or selected pages of a document. Typical usage may consist in writing words such as “DRAFT” or “CONFIDENTIAL” across document pages.

The package may remind in some sense `draftcopy` by Dr. Juergen Vollmer, but its implementation differs in a few points:

1. Code footprint is smaller, although this does not mean much on modern computers.
2. There is no use of Postscript specials or other driver-dependent tricks, so the package should be compatible with any output driver and with $\pdf\LaTeX$, $\Xe\LaTeX$, and $\Lua\LaTeX$ in particular. Recently, compatibility with PDF generating engines is quite important and its lack in `draftcopy` and was the first motivation for writing `draftwatermark`.
3. Reduced code footprint comes at some price. Many features of `draftcopy` are not supported here, most notably `draftwatermark` has:
 - No automatic selection of the watermark text to use, based on the language, relying on pre-stored translations of the word “DRAFT”. This may be no big loss, since one is free to choose whatever text he/she happens to prefer.
 - No automatic possibility to watermark only the first *two* pages of a document. However, it is possible to automatically watermark only the first or to *manually* stop the watermarking after the second page.

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[†]Sergio Callegari can be reached at `sergio.callegari at gmail dot com`